

Final project report/Report writing and structure/Required structure for you report

For this module, the overarching structure of your report is defined here, in addition to [formatting guidelines](https://minerva.leeds.ac.uk/webapps/blackboard/content/listContentEditable.jsp?content_id= 9528208_1&course_id= 533270_1) (https://minerva.leeds.ac.uk/webapps/blackboard/content/listContentEditable.jsp?content_id= 9528208_1&course_id= 533270_1).

Your report should be **no longer than 35 pages** (including references but excluding appendices). Page number start on the first page of the introduction (pages in the front matter should be numbered with Roman numbers).

Front matter (each should start on a new page, in the listed order)

- 2 cover pages (following a [template](https://minerva.leeds.ac.uk/webapps/blackboard/content/listContentEditable.jsp?content_id= 9528208_1&course_id= 533270_1) (https://minerva.leeds.ac.uk/webapps/blackboard/content/listContentEditable.jsp?content_id= 9528208_1&course_id= 533270_1))
- table of content
- [optional] table of figures, table of tables, nomenclature, ...
- abstract

Chapter 1: Introduction

Chapter 2: Literature review (+ if necessary Theoretical Background)

Chapter 3 - N-1: core chapters of your work

Chapter N: Conclusion

Back matter

- **References** (part of the page count)
- **Appendices** (not part of page count but should not contain information necessary for assessment: these pages may not be read by your examiners and as such should not contain any key information)

Note: number of pages for each chapter is indicative, and not a maximum number of pages. Each chapter should start on a new page.

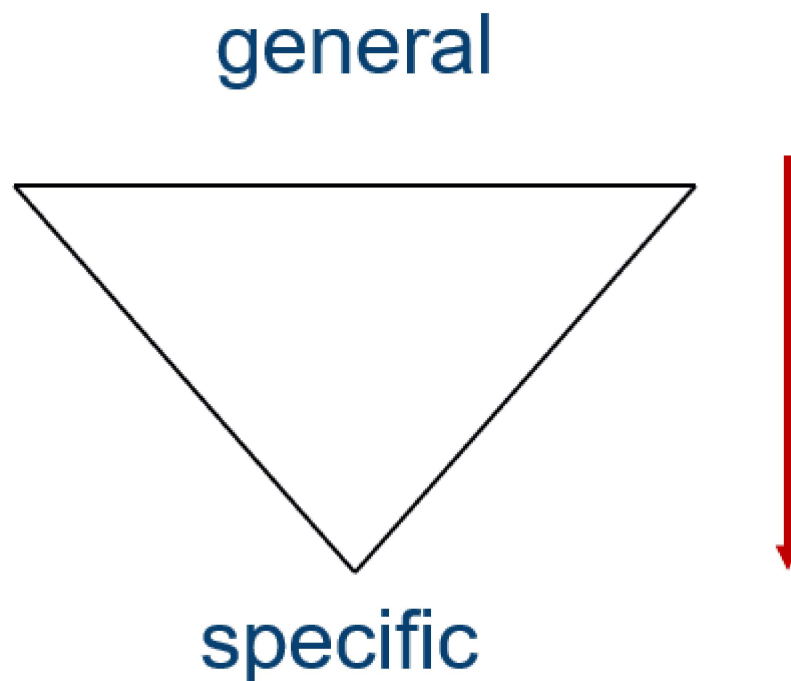
Chapter 1: Introduction

The role of the introduction chapter is to introduce the work within context, establish aims and objective, and provide a report layout. It should be 2 to 3 pages long. It explains in broad terms the work which was done in order to complete the project, leading to what your project was.

This chapter should be divided into 4 sections:

1.1 Introduction: This is an introduction to the overall project and its relevance. This is an extended version of the "scope" part of your scoping document. [about 1.5 pages] **1.2 Aim(s):** similarly to your scoping doc, this provide a succinct aim to the work **1.3 Objectives:** list of objectives supporting the aim, written as SMART objectives (see info in [scoping document template](https://minerva.leeds.ac.uk/webapps/blackboard/content/listContentEditable.jsp?content_id=9247448_1&course_id=533270_1) ([https://minerva.leeds.ac.uk/webapps/blackboard/content/listContentEditable.jsp?content_id= 9247448_1&course_id= 533270_1](https://minerva.leeds.ac.uk/webapps/blackboard/content/listContentEditable.jsp?content_id=9247448_1&course_id=533270_1)))

1.4 Report layout: this is a paragraph explaining in plain English what each chapter contains (it goes further than the content page as it can explain how chapters are linked or what the key message of the chapter is). See the project report FAQ for an [example](#) ([https://minerva.leeds.ac.uk/webapps/blackboard/content/listContentEditable.jsp?content_id= 9528212_1&course_id= 533270_1](https://minerva.leeds.ac.uk/webapps/blackboard/content/listContentEditable.jsp?content_id=9528212_1&course_id=533270_1)). [Up to about half a page]



When writing section 1.1, you should **start with broad information** related to the project area, then **gradually narrow the point** by provides a range of information that leads **to a focussed aim** of your work, adding more details as you get closer to your aim. It should answer questions such as

- Why is this question important?
- Why is this work being done? Why now? Why should the reader care?
- How has it been studied in your project?
- What is your contribution or hypothesis?

For example, if your project involves computer modelling of deformations in the hip soft tissues; you may want to start by introducing why deformation of the hip soft tissues are important to understand (with clinical information for instance, providing context), how many people suffer from diseases/pain due to these deformations, why you have chosen to focus on a particular tissue...; then you can mention why using computer modelling is a good method to use, what are the main limitations or key aspects to include, what can be done with computer models that cannot be done on people or in the lab; you then explain what your specific question / hypothesis is that you aim to answer with your model.

Chapter 2: Literature review (and if necessary Theoretical Background)

The role of the literature review is to provide further background (even if already touched upon in the introduction), inform about what research in the same or similar area already exist (answer questions such as: What is known up to date on the subject? Are there any gaps in the literature?), give background information about the methods and techniques you have used in your project (and how they have been used in similar work). It should be 8 to 12 pages long.

There need to be several sections and sub sections with a thorough review of the relevant literature: this is to give sufficient background information for the reader to understand what has been done in this area of research/work [this needs to showcase your critical analysis], and to provide enough background information of the type of analysis that was used to complete the project [this is more descriptive].

You can include theoretical background into this chapter or have a chapter on its own covering theory if a lot of it is required.

When writing your literature review, remember that we want to know your **understanding and analysis** of what others have done. Summarise and synthesise (https://library.leeds.ac.uk/info/14011/writing/106/academic_writing/4) the information rather than paraphrase other's writing. Quoting other's work should only be done sparsely, for famous quotes or agreed-upon definitions. Remember that we cannot assess your critical writing and your understanding of the literature if most of it is made of quotes!! Go back to "Recognising Plagiarism" (https://library.leeds.ac.uk/info/1401/academic_skills/46/academic_integrity_and_plagiarism/2)" information if you are unsure of what malpractice is; to the school lectures on academic integrity (https://minerva.leeds.ac.uk/webapps/blackboard/content/listContent.jsp?course_id=423009_1&content_id=5988835_1&mode=reset). Remember, you can borrow ideas from others, not words!

Chapter 3 to N-1: Your core work

These chapters form the basis of the report which details the work that you have done.

Your work should be grouped into 2 to 4 areas which are logically arranged in chapters in order to provide the reader with a logical and cohesive explanation of the work which was carried out.

Each chapter should present self-contained work. The title of a chapter should be as short and succinct as possible, yet long enough to give the reader sufficient information on the chapter content. You should NOT divide your report into chapters titled "Methods", "Results" (or wording with a similar meaning).

Each chapter should contain some short introduction, methodology, results and discussion on a particular aspect of your project.

The introduction can describe what the chapter is about, why it is necessary, explain how it is structured...

In the discussion, you should analyse and interpret your results, drawing from the information in which you have collected in the chapter and from the literature, explain its significance, identify important issues and limitations (which showcase the critical evaluation of your work), and suggest explanations for your findings. Make sure that each result presented has corresponding methodology and discussion (nothing should come as a surprised once the methods have been described).

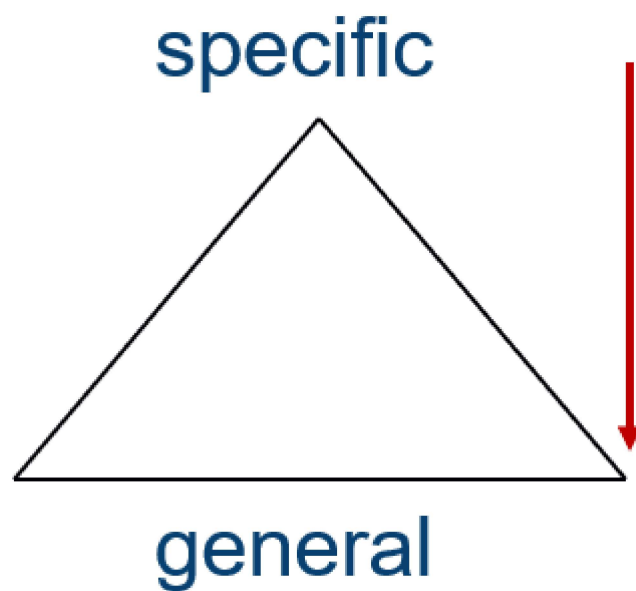
Chapter N: Conclusion (where "N" depends on the number of core chapters you have)

The concluding chapter should provide an overview of the findings and their meaning. It should be 1 to 3 pages long.

This chapter should be divided into 3 or 4 sections:

N.1 Achievements: List the things which were achieved in the project. Make it easy for the reader to understand what was achieved. Think about referencing back to the objectives. This can be a simple list or a coherent text. **N.2 Discussion:** This is where you link the findings of each chapter (for which you already have discussed the results) back to the scope and aim of the project. Analyse and interpret the range of findings you have found. Discuss the main advantages and limitations/weaknesses of the overall approach taken. **N.3 Conclusions:** this is where the conclusions of the work carried out are given. They usually summarise the findings, or key aspects of your discussion, or provide recommendations

[optional] N.4 Future work: this is here you can advise the reader of where future work can be undertaken



When writing section N.2, you should **start with specific information** related to your findings, then **gradually broaden the point** by providing a range of information that leads **to the project area**. It should answer questions such as

- What do the findings mean?
- Why does it matter? How do they, together, contribute to the aim of the work?
- Do they agree or contradict each other? How does this relate to the literature?
- What are the implications?

At the end of this section, you can also outline problems which you may have encountered. Try and present a balanced view (this is still about the work, not personal difficulties). This may be related to lack of access to resources, misunderstanding about aspects of the work (you may have thought that you were going to use an established methodology while you first had to develop a method or fix a testing rig...), inability to locate sources of errors...

References (in page count)

List all references used and cited in your report.

You can use Harvard or Numeric referencing.

Appendices (not in page count)

These pages are not assessed and should not contain any essential information!

You can have as many appendices as you want, which may include: hand calculations, workings of mathematical derivations, technical drawings, raw data, flowcharts... Anything that can help support the core information you present in other chapters but which is not necessary to understand your work.

You can't reference figures, tables or data from an appendix to the main part of the report. If these are necessary to understand your work then they should be in the core of the report!